

Inbox

Your feedback on the previous issue and other fan mail



Apple <3 AMD ?

If rumours are to be believed, Apple may soon have their products running on AMD chips

What's the buzz?

Your monthly mix of the hottest news from the world of technology

Bulletstorm announced for 2011

Electronic Arts, Epic Games and People Can Fly Games have confirmed the making of Bulletstorm, a wild and frantic first-person shooter that's set in a future where two mercenaries, Grayson Hunt and Ishi Sato, are exiled to a planet on the other side of the galaxy. Here the player steps into Grayson's shoes, and battles hordes of mutants and flesh eating gangs in a former utopia.

This is the first major public announcement of the game since 2008, when Epic announced EA would be the publisher of action games by People Can Fly. The makers of such top-selling franchises as Gears of War, Unreal Tournament, Medal of Honor and Painkiller promise to bring a wildly original first-person shooter to our shores in 2011, with its signature 'kill with skill' gameplay and stunning graphics based on the latest Unreal 3 Engine.

The 'skill-shot' XP system rewards the player with outrageously large guns and major character upgrades, and is supposed to induce "frantic game-

play" and "incite mayhem". No screenshots yet unfortunately.

Go screw yourself Apple

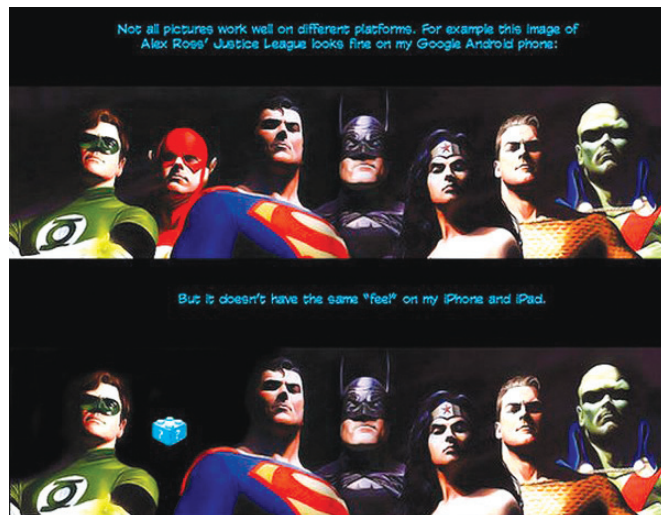
In a shocking, although not entirely unexpected move, Apple updated their new AppStore SDK terms such that applications compiled using the new Adobe Flash to iPhone compiler coming with Adobe CS5 will no longer be accepted. Section 3.3.1, which has now become a hot topic of discussion on the internet goes as follows: 3.3.1 – Applications may only use Documented APIs in the manner prescribed by Apple and must not use or call any private APIs. Applications must be originally written in Objective-C, C, C++, or JavaScript as executed by the iPhone OS WebKit engine, and only code written in C, C++, and Objective-C may compile and directly link against the Documented APIs (e.g., Applications that link to Documented APIs through an intermediary translation or compatibility layer or tool are prohibited).

One obvious target of this malice is Adobe Flash CS5 which will include the widely praised feature which allows one to create applications in Flash which can run on

the iPhone. Other frameworks such as MonoTouch, a version of Mono for the iPhone also fall victim to this new condition. The argument in favour of this move is that it will encourage a higher quality of the applications on the iPhone and encouraging developers to

platform code to be written for the iPhone using C++.

The controversy took a rather dramatic turn in the meanwhile. In retaliation, Adobe Platform evangelist Lee Brimelow wrote a rather strong blog post in which he said, "Speaking purely for myself,



No Flash: An internet joke doing the rounds right now

use native device features since these are many times sacrificed by cross-platform tools. Yeah, we all know how important it is to use the accelerometer while making a "fart" application. The App store will contain junk and poorly designed applications regardless, and an application should be allowed speak for itself.

While the reasoning that this is to maintain control of the platform makes a lot of sense, it falls short of accomplishing its goal. Toolkits such as Qt, which is written in C++ will allow for cross-platform content to be written for Windows, Mac OS, Linux, Maemo, and Symbian. People are hard at work to get it working for the iPhone as well. This would allow cross

I would look to make it clear what is going through my mind at the moment. Go screw yourself Apple."

Twitter's Chirp Conference

Twitter's official annual developer festival - 'Chirp' came to a fruitful close on the 15th of April and we bring you a complete roundup of the event, just in case you missed it. This was Twitter's first such developer meet, which is quite surprising as they have over 100,000 third-party applications already developed for their platform. At the conference, a lot of announcements were made about features that will be implemented in the near future, and about



Bulletstorm



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